

Diaspora ECONOMIC DOWNTURN

The American NIGHTMARE

For Indian immigrants who came to the US to better their futures, life seems to be in limbo with up to 50,000 expected back to pursue their dream here

| By Lavina Melwani in New York |

Jackson Heights, that pulsating Little India in New York, seemed a faint echo of its usual vibrant self on a recent Sunday. Weekends on 74th Street with scores of Indian businesses are usually a carnival with noisy traffic jams and people enveloping the sidewalks. This particular Sunday, one could actually get a parking spot, with just a small crowd purchasing essential groceries. America's economic crisis has now come into the

by-lanes of this thriving ethnic enclave, with even the price of daal going up.

Sam and Raj, a popular store on 74th Street, which in its heydays had been thronged by Indian tourists and immigrants alike for 110/220 volt electronic goods, stood silent, eerily deserted. The staff has been downgraded to just one person as owner Subash Kapadia pointed out: "Things are slow right now—instead of spending, people are waiting. People are scared to buy because they have lost money in the